NAME:	L DEEPAK SAI REDDY
ROLL NO:	251450523110
PROGRAM:	MBA
SEMISTER:	1
COURSE NAME:	MARKETING MANAGEMENT
CODE:	DMBA119

Assignment 1:

Question 1:

Define Marketing. What are the features of marketing?
Answer:
Marketing: It means finding out what customer need, understanding it, and satisfying them in a profitable way, it connects the business with the customer by creating the value, building the relationships and ensuring the loyalty, not just selling products.
It is a very old concept of civilization, even in the barter system people used to exchange the goods. Over the time it became the art of selling. In ancient days, people used symbols, signs and objects to communicate and make deals.
In recent era, the marketing even changed a lot with the help of internet the customers became smarter, and technology is moving fast, and new form of marketing came to handle new challenges. Modern marketing has the 4Ps (Product, Price, Place, and Promotion) and it goes more than profit to include social responsibility.
Features of Marketing:
Marketing is a dynamic thing that connects businesses with customers. It goes more than selling or advertising and contains identifying, anticipating, and satisfying customer needs and make them profitable.
Customer-Centric:
Marketing mainly focuses on knowing what customers want and giving them what satisfies them the most. For example, Amazon suggests products based on what you search or buy and give offers like free delivery via Prime that makes customers happy and loyal.
Value Creation:
Marketing is about generating real value for people by solving their challenges or improving their lives. Like Apple designs products that look good, work smoothly, and connect seamlessly with other Apple devices giving users the comfort and ecosystem.
Continuous Process:
Marketing never stops. It keeps changing with trends, technology, and people's preferences. Netflix is a good example it keeps adding new shows and uses data to suggest what viewers might like.
Relationship Building:
It's not just about one-time sales; it's about making long-term bonds with customers. Starbucks does this well with its rewards programme and special offers that make people come back again.
Integrated Function:
Marketing links all parts of a business together product design, promotion, and customer service to give one clear and strong message. Nike does this perfectly with its "Just Do It" campaigns and great customer experience through its app and services.
Conclusion: Marketing plays a pivotal role in the success of any business. It not only focuses on selling products but also on creating value, building relationships, and satisfying customer needs. The key features such as customer orientation, value creation, integration, and innovation make marketing an indispensable part of organisational strategy. In today's competitive environment, effective marketing helps organisations build strong brands, sustain profitability, and adapt to the ever-changing global marketplace.

Question 2:

List the 7p's of marketing. Explain any 3 of them (10 marks)
Answer:
The 7 Ps of Marketing, also known as the Extended Marketing Mix, represent a comprehensive framework used by organisations to design, implement, and evaluate effective marketing strategies. Initially, marketing was based on four key elements Product, Price, Place, and Promotion. However, to address the growing complexity of services and customer relationships, three additional elements — People, Process, and Physical Evidence were introduced. Together, these seven elements help businesses align their offerings with customer expectations and competitive market dynamics.

Significance of the 7 Ps in Marketing

- The 7 P's help businesses create a balanced marketing strategy that focuses on both tangible and intangible aspects of customer value.
- They ensure that every marketing decision aligns with organisational goals, customer needs, and competitive realities.
- In service-oriented industries such as hospitality or healthcare, factors like People, Process, and Physical Evidence play a crucial role in building trust and credibility.

7P's of Marketing: 7Ps are divided into 2 types

The Traditional 4Ps

1. Product
2. Price
3. Place
4. Promotion

Additional 3Ps

1. People
2. Process
3. Physical evidence

3Ps in Detailed:

People:
This element includes everyone involved in delivering a product or service employees, customer service staff, and even customers. Their behaviour and attitude affect customer satisfaction and brand image. In service industries, this is crucial. Starbucks trains its baristas to offer friendly and consistent service, creating loyalty. Virgin Atlantic ensures staff provide memorable experiences that enhance its reputation. Customers also influence perception through actions like online reviews. Businesses must encourage feedback and build a positive brand community. Well-trained, motivated staff and engaged customers help deliver great value and strong relationships.

Process:
Process refers to the systems and methods used to deliver products or services efficiently and consistently. McDonald's maintains the same quality and speed worldwide through standardised procedures. Amazon improves its delivery with one-click orders and tracking systems. Technology like chatbots and apps, such as Uber's ride-booking system, simplifies the customer experience. Efficient processes reduce errors, meet customer expectations, and build trust, making them essential to marketing success.

Physical Evidence:
Physical evidence includes the tangible elements that assure customers of quality and reliability, especially in services. Hotels like Hilton use clean, well-designed interiors to reflect professionalism. Apple's sleek packaging supports its premium image. In retail, store design and layout serve as proof of quality for example, IKEA's showrooms let customers visualise furniture in real-life settings.

Conclusion:
The 7 Ps of Marketing form the backbone of an effective marketing strategy. Each element from product development to customer experience contributes to overall brand success and customer satisfaction. By effectively managing these components, organisations can enhance value creation, strengthen their market position, and achieve long-term growth in an increasingly competitive business environment.

Question 3:

Define Segmentation. List the Steps in Segmentation.

Answer:

Meaning of Market Segmentation:
Market segmentation is the process of dividing a broad market into smaller, more homogeneous groups of consumers who share similar characteristics, preferences, or needs. This approach allows businesses to design and execute targeted marketing strategies that cater to the specific requirements of each segment. By segmenting the market, organisations can use their resources efficiently, develop customised products, and enhance customer satisfaction and retention.

Importance of Market Segmentation:

- It helps in identifying and understanding the needs of different customer groups.
- It enables effective targeting and positioning strategies.
- It assists in optimising marketing resources and improving profitability.
- It fosters long-term customer relationships through personalisation.

Steps in Market Segmentation:

I. Identify the Market and Define Objectives:
The first step is to clearly define the overall market and the purpose of segmentation. The organisation must determine whether the segmentation is aimed at introducing new products, repositioning existing ones, or improving communication strategies. For example, a company entering the electric vehicle market may segment customers based on income, environmental awareness, and usage patterns.

II. Determine the Basis of Segmentation
Segmentation can be based on different criteria such as demographic, geographic, psychographic, and behavioural factors. Demographic factors include age, gender, income, and education. Psychographic segmentation considers lifestyle, personality, and values. Behavioural segmentation focuses on purchasing habits, loyalty, and product usage.

III. Develop Market Segments
Once the criteria are chosen, customers are grouped into distinct segments that share similar characteristics. Each segment must be measurable, substantial, accessible, and actionable. For instance, a smartphone brand may create segments like budget-conscious users, tech enthusiasts, and business professionals.

IV. IV. Evaluate the Market Segments

Each segment must be assessed for its size, growth potential, profitability, and competitive intensity. Businesses must identify which segments align best with their capabilities and market goals. Evaluation helps in selecting the most attractive and sustainable segments.

V. Select the Target Segment:

After evaluation, companies select the most viable segments to focus on. Targeting strategies can be undifferentiated (same approach for all), differentiated (unique approach for each), or concentrated (focus on one segment). For example, luxury brands like Rolex use a concentrated targeting strategy focus Edon premium customers.

VI. Design and Implement the Marketing Mix:

The marketing mix (Product, Price, Place, Promotion) must be customised for the selected segments. This ensures that the marketing strategy resonates with the segment's needs and preferences.

VII. Monitor and Review Segmentation Strategy:

Market conditions and consumer behaviours evolve over time. Regular evaluation helps ensure the segmentation strategy remains effective and relevant. Adjustments may be required to maintain competitiveness.

Conclusion: Market segmentation is a vital tool that enables businesses to understand their customers deeply and serve them more effectively. By following a structured process from identifying the market to implementing and reviewing the strategy organisations can enhance customer satisfaction and achieve long-term profitability. Effective segmentation not only drives marketing efficiency but also strengthens the brand's position in a dynamic marketplace.

Assignment 2:

Question 4:

List the methods of pricing. Explain any 3 of them
Answer:
Meaning of Pricing:
Pricing is the managerial process of assigning a monetary value to a product or service to capture customer value, cover costs, and achieve organisational objectives such as profit, market share, or positioning.
Methods of Pricing (List):
Cost-plus pricing, markup pricing, target-return pricing, marginal (incremental) pricing, absorption-cost pricing, value-based pricing, competition/going-rate pricing, tender/sealed-bid pricing, skimming pricing, penetration pricing, psychological pricing, bundle pricing, dynamic (surge/yield) pricing, geographic pricing, discriminatory/segmented pricing, premium pricing, economy pricing, freemium and two-part tariff pricing.
Explanation of Any Three Methods:
I. Cost-Plus Pricing:
Definition: Price is computed by adding a fixed markup to unit cost (variable cost +allocated fixed cost).
Rationale: Ensures full cost recovery and a predictable profit margin; simple to administer and justify internally.
Suitable When: Demand is stable, cost data are reliable, and price transparency is acceptable (e.g., industrial components, government contracts).
Caveats: Ignores customer willingness to pay and competitor moves; risks overpricing in weak demand and under-pricing when demand is strong.
II. Value-Based Pricing:
Definition: Price is set primarily on the perceived value to the customer rather than on the seller's cost.
Rationale: Captures a fair share of created value by linking price to outcomes, savings, or experiences delivered (e.g., time saved, risk reduced).
Suitable When: Differentiation is strong, benefits are measurable, and segments can be educated about economic value (software, medical devices, B2B solutions).
Implementation Keys: Conduct economic value estimation, segment by willingness to pay, use proof points (case results, ROI calculators).
Caveats: Requires robust customer insight and credible communication; misjudging value can depress demand.
III. Penetration Pricing
Definition: Launching at a deliberately low price to quickly build volume, attract trial, and discourage rivals.
Rationale: Exploits price elasticity, accelerates network effects and learning curves, and raises entry barriers for competitors.
Suitable When: Market is price sensitive, economies of scale are significant, and rapid adoption is strategic (consumer tech, platforms, FMCG).
Execution Keys: Time-bound introductory prices, clear upgrade paths, vigilant cost control to protect margins as volumes rise.

Caveats: Risk of a “cheap” quality signal; difficult to raise prices later without added value or tiering.

Significance for Managers:

- Align pricing choice with positioning, elasticity, cost structure, and competitive intensity.
- Blend methods tactically (e.g., value-based list price with promotional bundles) while maintaining coherent brand signals.

Conclusion: An informed pricing strategy starts with a full toolbox and ends with disciplined choice. Cost -plus safeguards margins, value-based captures willingness to pay, and penetration accelerates scale. The best managers align method to market conditions, articulate value clearly, and iterate using data, thereby turning price into a durable source of competitive advantage.

Question 5:

Define Publicity. List the types of advertising with example.

Answer:

Meaning of Publicity:

Publicity refers to a non-paid form of communication aimed at promoting or influencing public perception about a product, service, or organisation. It involves disseminating information through media outlets, public events, or social discussions without direct payment by the company. It plays a key role in shaping public opinion, building credibility, and enhancing brand visibility. Since publicity comes from independent sources like news agencies or social media, it is perceived as more trustworthy than paid advertisements.

Importance of Publicity:

1. Publicity helps in creating awareness about the organisation’s activities or new product launches.
2. It enhances brand image and builds public trust through authentic coverage.
3. It serves as a cost-effective marketing tool that provides wide exposure without additional expenses.
4. IV. It contributes to reputation management and strengthens relationships with stakeholders

Difference Between Publicity and Advertising:

1. Publicity is unpaid and uncontrolled, whereas advertising is paid and controlled.
2. Advertising focuses on persuasion, while publicity focuses on information sharing and credibility.
3. Publicity often reaches audiences through news stories, press releases, and media reports, while advertising uses paid channels like TV, radio, or print.

Types of Advertising (List):

- Product Advertising
- Institutional Advertising
- Informative Advertising
- Persuasive Advertising
- Reminder Advertising
- Comparative Advertising
- Reinforcement Advertising

Explanation of Any Three Types of Advertising:

I. Product Advertising

Definition: Product advertising aims to promote a specific product or service to increase consumer demand.

Objective: To inform and persuade customers by highlighting product features and benefits.

Example: Samsung promotes its Galaxy smartphones through online ads demonstrating unique camera features.

Importance: It boosts product visibility and influences purchase decisions effectively.

II. Institutional Advertising:

Definition: This type of advertising focuses on building a positive image of the organisation rather than a particular product.

Objective: To create goodwill, enhance brand reputation, and build trust among the public.

Example: Infosys runs institutional advertisements showcasing its corporate values and community initiatives.

Importance: It helps in developing long-term credibility and brand loyalty.

III. Reminder Advertising:

Definition: Reminder advertising is used to keep a brand fresh in consumers' minds even after its initial popularity.

Objective: To maintain customer engagement and encourage repeat purchases.

Example: Amul regularly releases witty print ads to remind audiences about its long-standing brand presence.

Importance: It sustains brand recall and reinforces consumer connection.

Significance of Publicity and Advertising:

1. Both are integral to promoting products and enhancing market visibility.
2. Publicity provides authenticity, while advertising ensures consistent communication.
3. Their combined use enhances awareness, reputation, and profitability.

Conclusion: Publicity and advertising together form the backbone of modern marketing communication. While publicity enhances credibility through unpaid exposure, advertising ensures control and consistency of messaging. The different types of advertising, such as product, institutional, and reminder advertising, contribute to shaping consumer perceptions, maintaining engagement, and driving long-term brand success.

Question 6:

Write a note on Ethics in Marketing

Answer:

Meaning of Ethics in Marketing:

Ethics in marketing refers to the application of moral principles and values in the process of creating, promoting, and delivering products or services. It ensures that marketing activities are conducted fairly, truthfully, and responsibly, maintaining respect for consumers and society. Ethical marketing focuses on transparency, integrity, and accountability. It aims not only to satisfy customer needs but also to contribute positively to society and uphold the reputation of the organisation.

Importance of Ethics in Marketing:

1. It helps in building consumer trust by ensuring honesty and transparency in business practices.

2. It improves brand reputation and credibility in a competitive marketplace.
3. It promotes long-term customer loyalty through fair dealings and genuine communication.
4. It prevents legal issues and penalties by aligning marketing activities with ethical and legal standards.
5. It strengthens the organisation's social responsibility and corporate image.

Principles of Ethical Marketing:

1. Honesty and Fairness:

Marketers must provide true and complete information about products and avoid deceptive advertising. Ethical communication helps customers make informed decisions.

2. Transparency in Dealings:

Companies should be open about product pricing, quality, and limitations. Transparency fosters trust and maintain goodwill among customers.

3. Respect for Consumer Privacy:

Organisations must handle customer data securely and avoid misuse of personal information. Data collection practices should be transparent and consent based.

4. Social and Environmental Responsibility:

Ethical marketing promotes sustainable practices and discourages harm to the environment. Example: Companies using eco-friendly packaging or supporting social causes.

5. Avoiding Manipulative Tactics:

Marketers must not exploit emotions or spread misinformation to influence buying behaviour. Honest representation ensures long-term brand loyalty.

Examples of Ethical Marketing Practices:

- Tata Group focuses on integrity and social welfare, embedding ethics into every marketing initiative.
- The Body Shop campaigns for cruelty-free beauty products and fair-trade sourcing.
- Patagonia promotes environmental sustainability through responsible advertising.

Challenges in Implementing Marketing Ethics:

- Intense competition may push firms towards unethical shortcuts to increase profits.
- Cultural variations make it difficult to apply uniform ethical standards globally.
- Pressure to meet sales targets can lead to exaggerated or false advertising.
- The rise of digital marketing poses privacy concerns and data misuse risks.

Conclusion: Ethics in marketing plays a crucial role in ensuring fairness, transparency, and accountability in business practices. By prioritising integrity and social responsibility, organisations not only gain customer trust but also achieve sustainable success. Ethical marketing creates a balance between profit-making and societal welfare, establishing long-term goodwill and corporate excellence.